

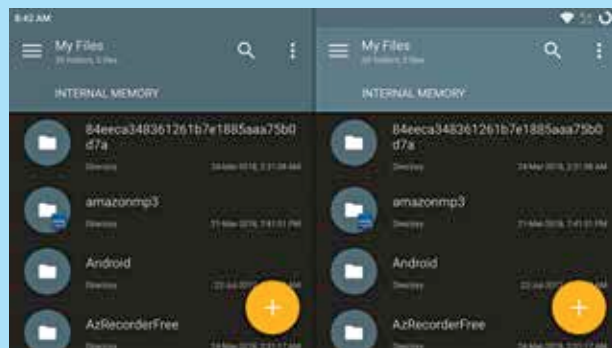


## CAMERA

You might never bother changing your default camera app. The basic camera app shipped by the manufacturer usually tends to do the job and sometimes includes hardware specific features. Users who are into photography might want to take things to the next level. That's where manual camera settings become necessary, something which is either limited or not user-friendly enough. Secondary camera apps that support manual settings will always offer more control over the camera. There are several good paid camera apps out there, but Open Camera is an impressive open source alternative.

For starters, Open Camera offers some easy to use features like auto-stabilise, which makes your disoriented pictures perfectly level. Tweaks within the app let you play with focus modes, scene modes, color effects, white balance, ISO, exposure compensation or exposure lock, face detection and artificial lighting. Some thoughtful features like UI customisation for left handed users, or the ability to take pictures while recording videos show you the benefits of using a popular, open sourced camera app instead of the default one.

**Open camera:** <https://dgit.in/OpnCmr>

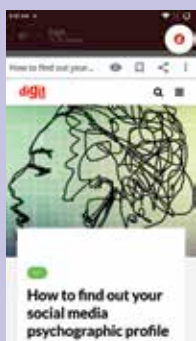


## FILE EXPLORER

The file explorer category goes through the same problem that the web browser category suffers from. Most of the people wouldn't bother to use anything beyond the default app as long as they can access their files. But when you want features like FTP connections, media server sharing, or you simply want to explore the files on your PC using your phone, you will need a third-party file explorer. ES File Explorer has been people's choice for a long time and for now, we would recommend Solid Explorer. We stopped using ES when the interface started including too many features and ruining the actual user experience.

Solid Explorer follows material design in a dual-pane window. It supports colour and theme customisation, which is always appreciated. If your phone is rooted, it will also give you root access to the restricted folders. With the help of a small plugin, you can setup an FTP server plugin on your phone and connect to your PC. So, Solid Explorer essentially offers most of the features that you would need from a file explorer, even if you're a power user, without being cluttered.

**Solid Explorer:** <https://dgit.in/SolidExplr>



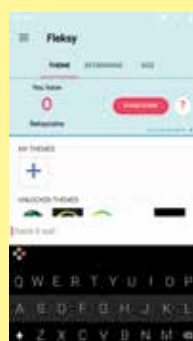
## SMS

The SMS app is another ignored application, where users stick with the default, unless you have the knack for security or customisation. Hence, we'll recommend two apps that you can choose. For those who are highly paranoid about their personal details stored in SMS messages, you should install Signal Private Messenger. The app is so secure that even whistleblower Edward Snowden

recommends it. You can protect your messages with a password and use the service as a messenger between other Signal users. You can even create group chats where not only are your chats secure, but even the group metadata, like the members list, are absolutely private. Now let us have a look at the customisation aspect. If you want your text messages to look good while you're reading them, you should try Mood Messenger. The app is really fast and you can select or customise several themes within.

**Signal:** <https://dgit.in/Sgnl>

**Mood Messenger:** <https://dgit.in/MoodMssngr>



## KEYBOARD

As an Android user, you must have enjoyed third-party keyboards for a long time. Manufacturers try to shake things up by adding changes to the Android AOSP keyboard. If they overdo it, users naturally install a third-party keyboard such as SwiftKey or GBoard. Although SwiftKey includes a massive number of features, we wanted to find something unique as an alternative. Gesture typing

is present on almost all the major keyboard apps but Fleksy offers a completely new style of typing. It follows a minimal approach, focussing on gestures to help you type faster. The keyboard enables different functions based on which direction you swipe. For example, swiping right adds a space and if there's no character, it adds a period. If you want to delete a word, all you need to do is swipe left over the keyboard. Changes can be made to auto-corrected text by swiping up and down to scroll through the suggestions. It also includes several themes and extensions to improve your typing experience.

**Fleksy:** <https://dgit.in/Fleksy>